

The Right Figure

The article ("The Wealth Effect", May 4) states the worth of the current assets of my client Padamsingh Bajirao Patil, NCP MP from Osmanabad, at Rs 105.32 crore. The article and the statement contained therein convey or intend to convey false information about my client's financial worth, and are damaging. **BHUSHAN V. MADHOK, Advocate, Mumbai**

We had taken the figures from the Association for Democratic Reforms (ADR) and have verified the figures with them again. The ADR had released wrong figures by mistake. The correct figure for the assets of Patil and his spouse is Rs 7.58 crore as per his affidavit. The error is regretted. **EDITOR**

Hard Lessons

The political crisis in Nepal sounds warning bells for India as well because pro-China Maoists may again turn to create anarchy after Prachanda's resignation ("A Himalayan Crisis", May 18). Today many countries are experiencing governance troubles, more so democracies. In the larger interest, the UN should draft a democratic system for all after studying the systems in various countries and difficulties experienced in following them. **SUBHASH AGARWAL, Delhi**

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What Lies Beneath

It is puzzling why the US is unable to understand Pakistan's obsessive animosity towards India ("The Spoils of War", May 18). The US should realise the inborn characteristic of Pakistan's dominant forces—its army and the ISI—who are only interested in militarily engaging India rather than helping their civilian establishment in the much-needed development of

Bimal Jalan, former governor of the RBI, has observed, politics is the most lucrative business and democracy is no more "of the people, by the people, for the people" but "by few, for few".

THOMAS GEORGE, Kochi

Way to Go

The action plan brings out lucidly the points on which a coalition of ideas must be built ("What India Needs", May 11). Absence

REUTERS



“ Though evidence holds Quattrocchi culpable, his closeness to Sonia Gandhi assured him protection. Nurturing the belief that loyalty pays, even Congressmen cooperated. ”

H.R. BAPU SATYANARAYANA, via www.indiatoday.in

their own nation. **V.S. GANESHAN, Bangalore**

Rich Order

The assets of our politicians are skyrocketing to astronomical heights ("The Growth Curve", May 18). The declared assets of the 543 elected MPs are more than Rs 3,075 crore, when 28 crore Indians are below the poverty line. As

of a deliberate consensus on these issues will, however, mean that competitive one-upmanship and faux ideology may cancel them out. The time and energy being expended on match-seeking will be better spent if the objective of establishing the new coalition is front-loaded. **BISHAN SAHAI, via www.indiatoday.in**

30
YEARS
AGO IN
INDIA
TODAY

JULY 16-31, 1979

Tragedy of Errors

It was a time of bitter indecision. Even as the first monsoon rains lashed the capital last week, the crisis of leadership in the two-year-old Janata Party finally boiled over. Vitriol flowed in Parliament House when it opened for the Monsoon Session, and the vendettas of a few aged men again flared up, threatening to destroy the flimsy edifice they had collectively built. But the man at the helm of the government, faced with the most violent shake-up of his long and embattled political career, remained rigidly unshaken. Caught in the crossfire of mass desertions and pointed assaults aimed at pulling him down from the coveted prime ministership, the stodgy, stoic, 83-year-old Morarji Desai remained unmoved by the spectacle of his tottering government. Even as the paranoia created by rising resignations and the prospect of a no-confidence motion reduced the top party leadership into panicky figures of pulp, Desai surveyed the scene with characteristic deadpan interest.



MORARJI DESAI